

Strategic increase of performance and awareness of fashion retail business Difa

Mid Term Report

BUSINESS DATA MANAGEMENT - CAPSTONE PROJECT

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2.Executive Summary

Strategic increase of revenue and Brand awareness for fashion retail business

DIFA Velachery is a women's fashion accessories franchise located in Chennai. The store operates under a Franchise Owned, Franchise Operated model and offers a wide range of affordable products such as earrings, bangles, neck sets, cosmetics, hair accessories, handbags, and other related items. It mainly serves students, working professionals, and families in the nearby area.

The business aims to provide affordable fashion accessories to a diverse local demographic but faces significant challenges with decreasing revenue and overall brand awareness surviving in intense local competition. During my discussion with the owner, two business concerns became clear. First, the store did not have a clear data-based view of product performance. Second, the business was continuously spending more than *Rs.40,000* per month on marketing, but the owner still felt that store awareness remained limited.

My earlier proposal relied too much on public online data and was inconsistent towards solving the real problem of the business, in this mid-term stage, after receiving the feedback I have shifted my work towards solving following problem statements:

- To optimize product overview and store performance that can retain or attract customers
- To provide impactful strategy for increasing brand awareness in highly competitive market alongside reducing high marketing cost of *40K* per month

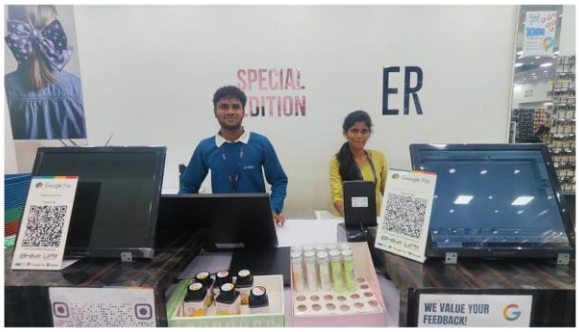
For first problem statement I have used actual primary business sales data shared by the owner in accordance with franchisee rules and for second problem statement I have surveyed online platforms to get potential micro-influencers that can exponentially impact the brand and customer retention overall

In the mid-term report, I first started the analysis for the first problem statement. The cleaned dataset contains *17,992* rows, *5,891* unique product identifiers, *89* item categories, *82,934* total units sold, and total revenue of *Rs.1,07,05,105.92* The initial analysis shows that the store sales and revenue is decreasing per month overall , Monthly sales and revenue show fluctuations, but no strong festive spike, including during the Diwali period. This supports the owner's view that the store depends more on regular demand than on seasonal buying fluctuations during seasonal demands.

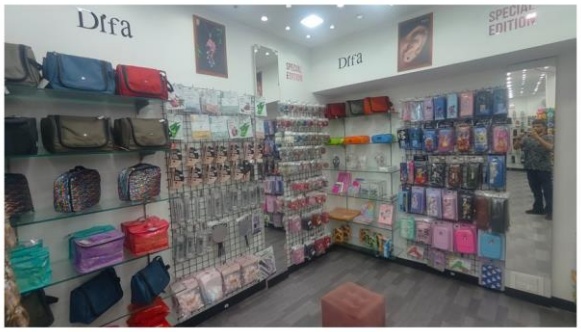
The price segmentation shows that the store mainly operates in the affordable accessories segment, with the most unique products concentrated in *Rs.50 to Rs. 500* range.

In the final report, I will build on this base item-category portfolio quadrant analysis, Heat map analysis, realized price per SKU on which customers are buying to help owners get overview of store products related demand and a structured shortlisting of local micro-influencers for improving marketing efficiency.

3.Proof of originality



Store counter with two salespeople standing



Instore view of store collections



Store outside front view



Me and one of the owners (Ms. Mani) standing at entrance

- Proof of Originality Drive Link: Drive link
- NIFT students' data and proof of scrapping: Nift students
- Excel link with business data set: link
- Business Model Canvas and Swot analysis: Link

4.Meta Data:

Metadata is used here to explain the structure of the dataset, the level of analysis, and the meaning of the key variables that I used in this study.

The raw data was first preserved in its original form. I then cleaned the dataset only to improve clarity, consistency, and readiness for analysis. The main steps are listed below.

- I renamed the original Item Name field as Item Category because it represented a broad category rather than a unique SKU.
- I created a composite primary key called UID using Item Category, Subcategory, Brand, Colour, and MRP.
- I combined all discount-related columns into one Discount field after checking that each row either had all zero discounts or only one active discount type.

  The formula used for checking (*=NOT(AND(P2+Q2+R2+S2+T2>P2,P2+Q2+R2+S2+T2>Q2,P2+Q2+R2+S2+T2>R2, P2+Q2+R2+S2+T2>S2,P2+Q2+R2+S2+T2>T2))*), When all rows resulted as True I was confirmed to combine category of discounts into one
- I derived Item Price using Item Gross divided by Sold Qty.
- I did not apply any filters to remove rows from the cleaned data.
- I have removed one row from raw data which was recorded due to system glitch as confirmed by the owner, description of deleted row is:
  - **Month:** September 2025
  - **Item:** WATCHES (CHAIN TYPE)
  - **Brand / Color:** MSY / BLACK
  - **Sold Qty:** 0
  - **Item Gross:** 0
  - **Item Net Amount:** 0
  - **MRP:** 429
- I have removed certain data types irrelevant for the analysis as they described the store location and freight charges.

Return transactions remain part of the dataset. Since returned items are marked with negative sold quantity, they automatically reduce the positive sold quantity and revenue values. For this reason, the sales and revenue totals reported in this study already reflect actual net movement. Some data restrictions were applied by the owner before sharing the raw file in order to protect franchise integrity and confidentiality. Even with those restrictions, the dataset retained all the item-level, quantity-level, and revenue-level details needed for the present analysis.

Note: The raw and cleaned dataset contains monthly item-level sales records shared by the business. Each row represents the monthly sales record of a unique product variant. The dataset does not

contain customer names, customer IDs, or transaction timestamps. Therefore, it is suitable for product, revenue, and category analysis, but not for customer retention or repeat-customer analysis.

Variable	Meaning	Significance
Month	Month of transaction record	Monthly trend analysis
Item Category	Broad product category	Main grouping for products
Sub Category	Specific type within category	Part of UID creation
Brand	Brand name/code	Part of UID creation
Colour	Product colour	Part of UID creation
item code	category code	Support field
item alias	category code	Support field
Sold Qty	Units sold	Sales measuring unit
Free Qty	Promotional units	Support field
Item Price	Derived unit price	Price understanding
Discount	Merged discount field	Pricing simplification
item amount before vat	Item price - Discount	support field
Vat amount	Vat charges	support field
Item Net Amount	Final realized revenue	Main revenue measure
Transaction Type	Sales or return	Return logic check
MRP	Maximum retail price	Price range analysis
UID	Composite primary product key	Unique SKU identification

Chart describing data labels in clean excel

Item pricing structure documentation: Link

Data Sourcing workflow:

Influencer Lead Generation & Sourcing Strategy

Methodology: Instagram was utilized as the primary platform for lead generation. A dedicated, purpose-built account was created to seamlessly map and penetrate the local student network. The sourcing funnel was initiated by targeting official NIFT Chennai pages, which served as the anchor. From there, the search was expanded organically by mining the likes, comments, and mutual connections of prominent public student profiles to discover highly engaged secondary leads.

Targeting & Selection Criteria Candidates were rigorously filtered based on the following parameters:

- Demographic Profile: Primarily female students, specifically local Chennai natives belonging to the graduating Class of 2029.
- Content Quality: Profiles demonstrating a strong aesthetic sense, featuring high-quality photoshoots and travel-oriented content.

- Performance Metrics: Highly active accounts with a consistent cadence of recent posts and proven reach, characterized by viewership ranging from thousands to millions.

Cost Efficiency: it can replace one stagnant ₹40k professional with 40 highly active NIFT students at just ₹1,000 each, drastically lowering the acquisition costs
Trend Authority: As Gen Z fashion students, they dictate trends and lend instant, credible fashion authority to the store within 5 km.
Exponential Fission: Hiring a few students triggers FOMO among their peers, creating a self-recruiting, viral marketing loop across the campus.
Hyper-Local Engagement: Their Instagram audiences are local and highly engaged, directly translating digital views into immediate physical footfall.
Authentic Content: They can integrate the brand into their daily fashion projects, producing organic, high-impact promotion that audiences trust over re-iterated boring ads.

Description of choosing Nift students

Variable	Meaning	significance
user id	Unique identifier of the user/account	User-level tracking & identification
Proxy name	Assigned alias for each user	Easy reference & anonymization
followers	Total number of followers	to review conversions
passout	graduation time	to review whether the student can come regular and to determine cash needs/projects
gender	sex	supporting field
most viewed count (in K)	Highest views received on a post (in thousands)	Viral content identification and capability
Last post date	Date of most recent post	Recency & activity tracking

Meta description of NIFT students data

5.Descriptive statistics:

Metric	Value
Total rows in clean data	17,992
Total UIds	5,891
Total Unique categories	89
Total Sales	82,934
Total revenue	₹ 1,07,05,105.92
Total sales excluding December*	81,858
Total revenue excluding December*	₹ 1,05,48,779.92
Avg sales per month	10,232
Avg revenue per month	₹ 13,18,597.49

Descriptive sheet 1 : Overview of data

Month	Revenue (Rs.)
April	14,00,160.29
May	14,51,673.00
June	13,13,824.01
July	11,91,258.49
August	14,89,975.98
September	11,27,470.50
October	14,41,718.30
November	11,32,699.35
December*	1,56,326.00

Descriptive sheet 2 : Revenue generated per month

Month	Units Sold
April	11,457
May	11,071
June	9,991
July	9,755
August	11,865
September	9,142
October	10,409
November	8,168
December*	1,076

Descriptive sheet 3: Quantity sold per month

Price Range (Rs.)	Number of unique SKUs
0-50	2,048
50-100	3,269
100-200	6,267
200-500	5,431
500-1,000	482
1,000-1,500	239
1,500-2,000	131
2,000+	55

Descriptive sheet 3: Price band analysis

6.Detailed explanation of analysis Process/Method:

At this point, the main need was to understand what the business data says about product movement, revenue, and price structure before going into deeper category-level decision analysis.

• The descriptive analysis 1: I used a pivot table to do the analysis, it was done to overview the overall store revenue, sales, Quantify total categories and unique SKUs in the store.

• The descriptive analysis 2 & 3: Month-wise trend analysis was used because the available data includes month information and the owner had raised concerns about store performance over time. It clearly describes the pattern/fluctuations in the entire time period

Process implemented: I have used pivot table to aggregate the sale qty variable per month to get description about sales data and used item net amount variable to aggregate total revenue per month .Note: December is not included to examine the trend due to availability of only first week of data

• The descriptive analysis 4: UID-based price segmentation with Pareto chart distribution was used to get over-view about the inventory MRP structure.

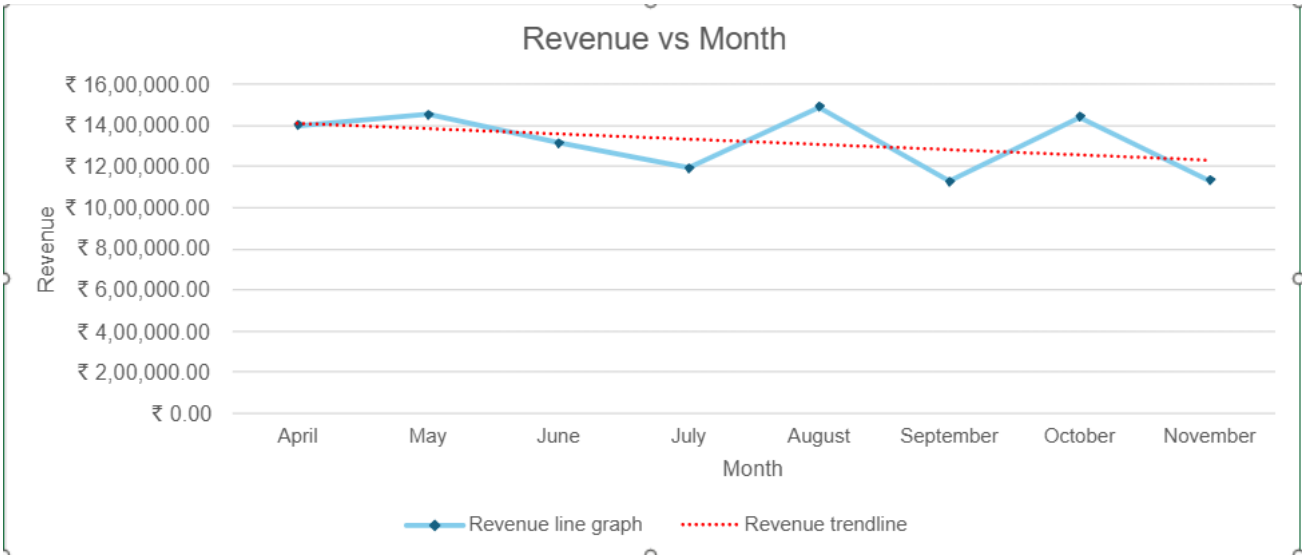
Process implemented: I have used a pivot table to a clean data set to arrange the MRP in row, aggregated count of UIDs and simply used the below formula to get the MRP in the band. The segmentation category was created based on typical Indian store MRP structure.

```
=IFS(VALUE(A4) <= 50, "0-50", VALUE(A4) <= 100,
"50-100", VALUE(A4) <= 200, "100-200",
VALUE(A4) <= 500, "200-500", VALUE(A4) <= 1000,
"500-1000", VALUE(A4) <= 1500, "1K-1.5K",
VALUE(A4) <= 2000, "1.5K-2K", VALUE(A4) >=
2000, "2K+")
```

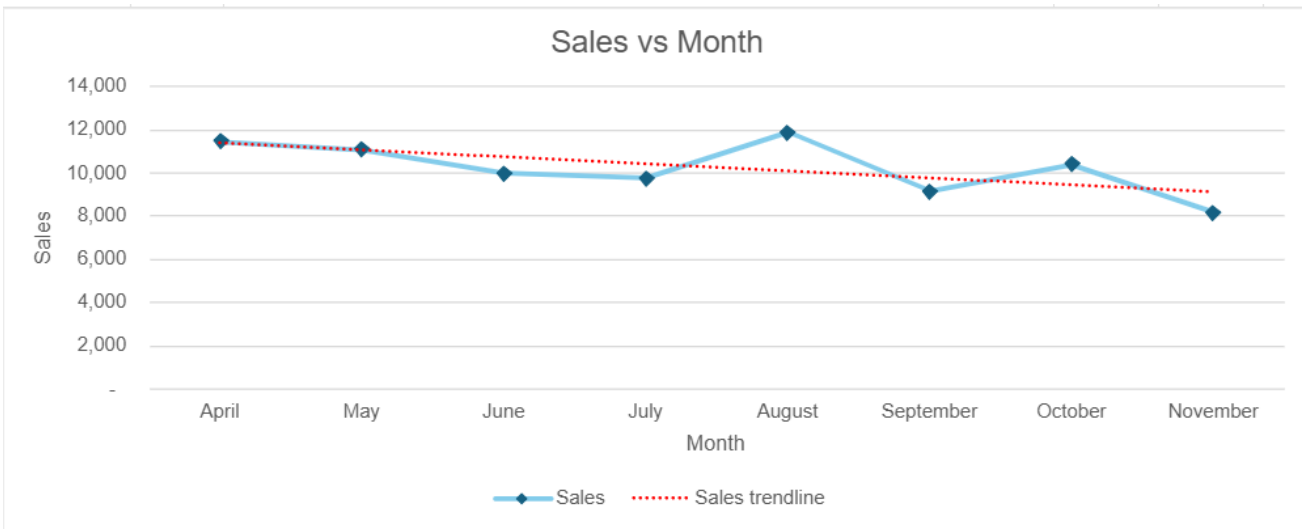
	A	B	C
	MRP	Count of UID	Category
	100.00	3.00	50-100
	1009	5.00	1K-1.5K
	1019	7.00	1K-1.5K
	102	1.00	100-200
	1029	4.00	1K-1.5K
	103	3.00	100-200
	1039	1.00	1K-1.5K
	104	3.00	100-200
	1049	6.00	1K-1.5K

Excel was used because the owner-shared data was already in spreadsheet format, and the present mid-term stage mainly required cleaning, aggregation, pivot tables, and charts. At this stage and later advanced predictive modeling was neither necessary nor suitable for the problem being addressed.

7.Result and findings:



Line graph of Revenue vs Month

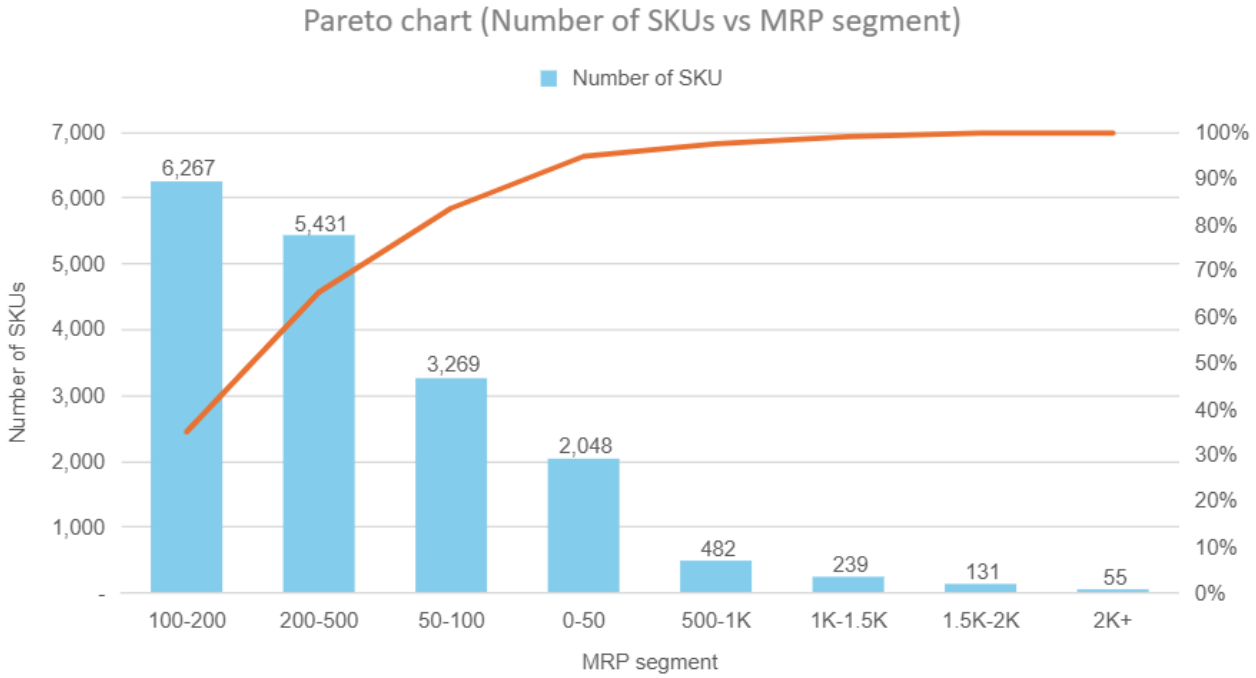


Line graph of Sold quantity vs Month

1). The trendline shows net decrease depicting low customer footfall over the period, The periodic variations are mainly caused but not limited to seasonality changes (Rainfall month, occasions like wedding and festivals, Higher number of weekends)

2). August had the highest sales due to less rainfall and festive season, November and September received the low sales due to heavy rainy season in Chennai and pre-post period around Diwali

3.) From April to July we can see approximately steady decrease with less fluctuations in sales and revenue depicting lower customer awareness after store launch



- The MRP segment Pareto chart distribution was calculated using UID. The chart reflects the number of unique product variants in each price band. The store's assortment is heavily concentrated in the lower price ranges, especially Rs. 100-200 and Rs. 200-500 depicted by a cumulative percentage pareto curve. Very few products lie above Rs. 1,000. This shows that the store mainly targets affordable fashion purchases rather than premium jewelry segments.